

Rescue



A firefighter carries a man out of a burning room. The rescued man cannot walk himself out. The rescuer went in on purpose.

Before you gather

- Read Day 24, Rescue, in The Visual Gospel. Do not reteach the essay.
- Read Mark 2:1–12 in your Bible. The excerpt below is only a backup.
- Your people should already have answered the day's reflection questions. Do not ask those again.

- Leave with a name. The missional challenge only works if someone is named before you pray.

1 • ICEBREAKER • 7 MIN

Open the room

If your house caught fire, who would you call first, and why that person?

Leader. A name, and a reason: near, able, willing. Do not ask anyone to narrate a trauma. The book already asked what God rescued them from. Say that passing is allowed, especially the first few weeks.

2 • THE WORD • 8 MIN

See it, then say it

IF YOU NEED THE WORDS

Say: Jesus does not shout instructions into a burning house. He goes in. He has delivered us from the domain of darkness and transferred us into His kingdom. Our help is not the rescue. He is.

DEFINITION, FROM THE BOOK

Rescue, or deliverance, is God saving people from danger, freeing them from sin, evil, and judgment, both now and forever through Jesus.

IN THE ORIGINAL LANGUAGE

Greek *rhuomai* — to rescue, to deliver, to draw someone out of danger.

MEMORY VERSE • COLOSSIANS 1:13

He has delivered us from the domain of darkness and transferred us to the kingdom of his beloved Son.

Together, open the flashcard for Rescue. Say the word, the definition, and the verse once. Then put the phone away.

3 • OPEN THE BIBLE • 15 MIN

Mark 2:1–12

Friends tear open a roof because a man cannot get himself to Jesus. Jesus forgives his sins first, then raises him. Colossians 1:13 is the memory verse: a change of kingdom, not only a change of mood. This story shows the rescue Jesus leads with.

And they came, bringing to him a paralytic carried by four men. And when they could not get near him because of the crowd, they removed the roof above him, and when they had made an opening, they let down the bed... And when Jesus saw their faith, he said to the paralytic, "Son, your sins are forgiven." ... "But that you may know that the Son of Man has authority on earth to forgive sins" — he said to the paralytic — "I say to you, rise, pick up your bed, and go home." And he rose and immediately picked up his bed and went out before them all.

Have two readers if you can. Bibles open. The excerpt is only here so a forgotten Bible does not stop the night.

From the passage

1. What did the friends seem to want, and what did Jesus give first? CORE

Leader. They brought a body. He said, "Son, your sins are forgiven," then told him to rise. The deepest rescue is deliverance from sin into His kingdom, not only relief from the stretcher.

2. How did the man get into the room? What does that show about his ability, and about theirs?

Leader. He was carried. Friends can bring a person toward Jesus. They cannot be the Savior. Our help is not the rescue.

4 · AROUND THE ROOM · 20 MIN

A conversation this chapter did not assign

3. Colossians 1:13 says He delivered us from a domain and transferred us into the kingdom of His beloved Son. A domain is a government. What still tries to give orders to a Christian Jesus has already moved? CORE

Leader. Shame, a habit, an old crowd, despair, the approval of people. Transfer means a new King. The old ruler does not get a spare key. Answer him with the Word, not with a feeling that you are still his.

4. Psalm 40:1–2: He drew me up from the pit and set my feet on a rock, and the psalm includes waiting. Why is waiting not the same as God failing to come?

Leader. His time and ours often differ. Waiting belongs to many deliverances. It is not proof you are still in the old kingdom. Jesus has already transferred His people.

5. The four made a hole in someone else's roof. What is a costly, practical way this group could carry someone toward Jesus without pretending to be their savior?

Leader. A ride, a meal, a seat beside you in the service, a sentence that names Christ. Costly and specific. Not "we should love people more." Our help points. Jesus delivers.

5 • SAY IT • 5 MIN

In one sentence

Rescue means Jesus delivers people from the domain of darkness and brings them into His kingdom.

Ask for two volunteers, not the whole circle. They may look at the sentence, then try it without looking. Clumsy and true is the goal.

6 • THIS WEEK • 5 MIN

Missional challenge

Before next week, carry this word to someone far from Jesus — a neighbor, a classmate, a coworker, a friend. Do it with a real action and with a true sentence. Name the person before you pray.

Step into one real trouble with someone far from Jesus and help with what is actually over them. Say that Jesus delivers people from darkness into His kingdom, and that your help is not the rescue.

Leader. You are not the crisis team. If it is beyond you, help the person get real help, and stay nearby. Name Christ. Do not call your help the rescue. Next week, before the icebreaker, take one minute. Who went, and what happened? One sentence. No speeches.

7 • PRAY • 8 MIN

Pray these, and leave room for others

1. Thank Jesus for coming into the darkness and transferring His people into His kingdom.
2. Pray by name for someone you would carry to Him if you could get them to the roof.
3. Ask Him to silence an old master that still tries to give orders.

Before you stumble

The drawing is strong, and the book speaks of real evil, including trafficking. Do not ask anyone to describe abuse, violence, or their worst day. Say: “You do not owe this room your worst day.” If someone discloses harm, believe them, stop the group from fixing it in public, and follow up with real help. Deliverance is first forgiveness and a new King (Colossians 1:13). Jesus does heal bodies. Do not promise a stretcher on your timetable. Ongoing suffering is not weak faith.

WITH STUDENTS

Ask what carrying a friend looks like when the friend does not want church. Honor courage. Forbid gossip dressed up as concern. Name Jesus. Do not play savior.

IF YOU STILL HAVE TIME

Acts 26:17–18. Jesus sends Paul to open eyes, so people turn from darkness to light and receive forgiveness. Mission is rescue under His authority. We carry. He delivers.